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Date: 12 Nov 2026

21LEM202T — Unit 4, Session 4, SLO 1

Part A — Key Ideas (Recap)

- Existence = Exist + Essence – whatever exists is/has to be in harmony (mutual fulfilment).
  - Existence = Co-existence = Units submerged in Space; it is ever present.
  - Units are limited in size and are activity/active; Space is unlimited, all-pervading and is no-activity (kriya-shoonya).
  - Every unit is energised in space, self-organised in space, and recognises & fulfils its relationship with every other unit in space.
  - Units are of two kinds: Material (recognising, fulfilling; temporary) and Consciousness / Self (knowing, assuming, recognising, fulfilling; continuous). Space is ever – unbounded in time and space.
  - Nature is a collection of units in four orders: Physical (soil, metal), Bio/Pranic (plants, trees), Animal (animals, birds) and Human (human being).
  - The physical, bio and animal orders – and space – are already in harmony. Only the human-order part (right understanding & right feeling → definite human conduct) is remaining, and it has to happen in the Self, by the Self.
  - Role of the human being: (1) to understand the inherent harmony / co-existence, and (2) to live accordingly – with the feeling of harmony or co-existence.
  - Fluid = the liquid used by a bio-order unit for nurturing (e.g. juice, water); Lump = a gross aggregation of molecular structure(s) (e.g. a rock, a log of wood, a piece of iron).
  - Space is called shoonya because it is no-activity – not a thing, not a unit, not an activity. It is a reality: "no-thing", not "nothing".

  This is a recap section with no blanks to fill; the student is expected to read and understand the key ideas.

Part B — In-Class Activity

Activity 1: For each unit below, tick whether it is a Material unit (only recognising & fulfilling) or a co-existence of Consciousness and Material (also knowing & assuming).

Unit	Material only	Consciousness + Material
Water	✓	
Human being		✓
Mosquito		✓
Dog		✓
Parrot		✓
Lizard		✓
Mango tree	✓	
Grass	✓	
Moon	✓	

Activity 2: Complete the comparison from the lecture.

Aspect	Units	Space
Size	Limited in size	**Unlimited / all-pervading**

Aspect	Units	Space
Activity	**Active (energised & self-organised)**	No activity
Presence in space	Energised & self-organised in space	**All-pervading, inactive container**

Activity 3: Match each order to its example units.

Order	Example units
Physical (Padarth)	**Soil, water, air, metal**
Bio / Pranic (Pran)	**Grass, tree, plant**
Animal (Jeev)	**Dog, cow, mosquito, parrot**
Human (Gyan)	**Human being**

Part C — Long-Answer Questions

1. Explain the statement "Existence = Co-existence = Units submerged in Space." In your answer, say what "units" and "space" mean and how they differ. (5 marks)

The statement means that existence is not a single homogeneous thing but a dynamic co-existence of two distinct realities: units and space. Units are limited, active, energised entities (like a human, a tree, or a stone) that are self-organised and have specific properties. Space is unlimited, all-pervading, inactive, and provides the medium in which units exist. The key difference is that units are finite and active, while space is infinite and inactive. Existence is the harmonious relationship where all units are submerged in space, each maintaining its own nature while coexisting.

2. Distinguish a material unit from a consciousness unit, giving one example of each from the slides. (5 marks)

A material unit (e.g., water) only recognises and fulfils its physical needs; it has no consciousness, no knowing or assuming. A consciousness unit (e.g., a human being) has both consciousness and material; it can know, assume, and choose its goals, in addition to recognising and fulfilling physical needs. Material units are limited to the physical order, while consciousness units belong to the animal or human orders and have the capacity for self-awareness and purposeful action.

3. "Harmony is inherent in existence; we do not have to create it." Explain this, and then state what the human being's role is in existence. (5 marks)

This means that existence is already a self-organised, co-existent whole where every unit naturally fulfils its role in relation to others — there is no inherent chaos or struggle. For example, the physical order supports the bio order, which supports the animal order, and so on. The human being's role is not to create harmony but to recognise this inherent harmony through self-reflection and to live in accordance with it, ensuring mutual fulfilment rather than exploitation. By understanding our own needs and goals correctly, we can participate in existence harmoniously.

4. Take the four Self-Reflection questions from the lecture and write your own honest answer to each, right now. (5 marks)

Self-Reflection (Take-Home)

- Is Nature / Existence self-organised, or is it a chaos?
- Is struggle inherent in Nature / Existence, or is there co-existence?
- Is there "survival of the fittest" in Nature / Existence, or is there mutual fulfilment?
- Have we recognised our self, our needs / goals correctly?
- Nature / Existence is self-organised — everything has its place and function, and the whole works without external control.
- There is co-existence inherent in Nature; struggle is a result of ignorance, not a fundamental law.
- There is mutual fulfilment, not survival of the fittest — each unit supports others in a web of

interdependence.

• I have not fully recognised my self and my needs/goals correctly yet; I am still learning to distinguish my true needs (happiness, harmony) from superficial desires (accumulation, competition).